YOUR ONLINE PRESENCE

HOW CAN I BEST PROMOTE MYSELF AND MY PRACTICE ONLINE?

5 QUESTIONS TO ASK YOURSELF BEFORE BEGINNING

1. Decide on the Basics

What kind of website do you need?
Do you need multi-media capabilities (audio, video, etc.)? What social media?
What is your voice?

Side Note: if you are having trouble getting started, check out artists you like and their websites to start generating ideas for your own work. Also check out industry websites and sites that focus on online marketing.

2. Look at your audience

Who is your current audience?
What audience do you want to reach but haven't already?
Define who you want your work to get in front of and brainstorm how to find and connect with those people.

3. Set your goals for Yourself

What goals can you set?
What would you like to have established in one month? Three months? Six months? A Year?
How many followers would you like to have? Email suscribers? Page views? New opportunities?

4. Your Online Habits

What do you already use or look at most online?
Make sure you are putting your professional presence online using tools and media you are interested in.

5. Understand Your Timing

How much time do you have for this?
Online presence is a lot to handle. How much are you able and willing to incorporate into your daily routine?

WEBSITES, BLOGS AND E-NEWSLETTERS

CHECK LIST FOR SUCCESS

- Do your research
- Keep it simple & make it easy to navigate
- Test it on different browsers & devices
- Make it easy to update
- Edit. Then edit some more.
- Protect your work.
- Integrate everything.

Great list to use as you are building your website, blog or e-newsletter.
When you are done, check back to make sure you have done them.

GENERAL GUIDELINES

Make a Good Impression

Your website may be the first or most regular encounter that people have with you and your work. Make it memorable.

Reflects Your Work and Personality

It is important thatthese are reflections of the kind of work you make and speaks to the audience you would want to reach. Look over other websites of artists and businesses in your field. Which ones do you really like and why?

Don’t Cut Corners, Invest When You Can

Little things like upgrading from a free to a paid site, hiring a photographer, writer or videographer to document and edit your work and having a custom URL of your name, band or collective go a long way!

SITES TO HELP YOU GET ONLINE

Template-based Sites and Site Builders

What are these? These are websites that help you set up your own site using pre-coded templates. These are good sites to use for people who have little time to update, maintain and design their websites. Your options include sites like:

Free	Low Cost	Additional
Word Press	Other Peoples Pixels	Coroflot
Wix	Xhbtr	Indexhibit
Weebly	Indiemade	
	Squarespace	
	Virb	

Domain Name Sites

What are these? These are websites that help you get your own domain name so your site reads just “yourname.com”.
Your options include sites like Namecheap, Go Daddy, Media Temple, and Host Gator.

Train and Do it Yourself

If you don’t know how to build a website or code, that is OK! There are variety of sites that will provide various degrees of finifhed website templates that you just have to upload your material to. There are also sites you can use to teach yourself how to build websites and code if you want to have a website that is more tailored to your aesthetic.

- Webydo offers graphic designers the option of creating a website without knowing code while still giving the user the option to change the templates to fit their needs. Free sites available. Other creatives may want to check out this site too.

- As an SAIC student, you have access toLynda, a website offering up-to-date tutorials on all kinds of software. If you do not want to use a template-based website then this site will be helpful because it includes tutorials to teach yourself HTML/CSS on software like Dreamweaver (Used to help code and build websites from scratch).

Are you an SAIC student, alumni, faculty or staff? Then access it here.

Protect Your Work

Below are great resources to look into for protection of your work online. These sites include resources for people with print and online material.

Step-by-Step Instructions

http://copyright.gov/

Additional Resource

http://law-arts.gov/

INTEGRATING WITH YOUR OTHER MEDIA

TWO WAYS TO SYNC MEDIA

Sites that Help You Sync Media

Hot Suite is a great example of a site that helps sync your social media like Twitter and Facebook by allowing you to post simultaneously or at specified dates/times per media outlet. Keep in mind you do not need to sync everything- sometimes just sharing ideas from one platform to another every so often is enough.

Sites that Allow You to Sync Easily

Another idea is to utilize websites that give you the option to sync your online portfolio or website with your other online accounts. One great example is Behance for your online portfolio. It can link to your Twitter, LinkedIn, Google and Facebook under “Me” then “Linked Accounts”. You can also do this on your website by including icons that take viewers to your other sites or vice versa. See Anna Russett’s site as an example for utilizing a website to connect to your other

PEOPLE WHO SYNC THEIR SITES

LinkedIn in sync with Behance

1. Steve Simpson - An Illustrative Freelance Designer
LinkedIn & Behance

2. Ramin Nasibov - Art Director and Graphic Designer
LinkedIn & Behance

3. Irina Vinnik - Illustrator
LinkedIn & Behance

4. Magda Sierzputowska -Graphic Designer
LinkedIn & Behance

Behance with other Social Media

1. Jennifer Yung - Designer

2. Tiffany Holmes - Artist

Social Media with Websites and/or Vice Versa

1. Richard Herns - Painter

2. Heidi Parkes - Quilt Artist

3. Tempest Hazel - Co-Founder of Sixty Inches From Center

IN THE WORLD OF SOCIAL MEDIA

THREE TIPS FOR SUCCESS

1. Integration - Make a chart for yourself

Like mentionned above in integration with other Media, sync your various platforms. This include cross-channel marketing by assigning roles to each application and tie them together for a more contextual message. Make sure you continue to evaluate what content works best or which channel too.

Example of assigning roles to your different social media outlets. Which one says what?

 Facebook	 Twitter	 LinkedIn	 Pinterest	 Google+
Behind the scenes photos	Blog posts, interesting articles	Product Updates	Product photos	Behind the scenes photos
Quotes	Quotes	Blog Posts	Guides, eBooks & white papers	Videos
Fill-in-the-blank	Industry news	Industry news	Videos	Event information
True or False questions	Vine or Youtube videos	Recruitement videos	Info-graphics	Blog posts
Blog posts	Event updates	Job postings	Quotes or tips	Industry news
Newsletter or announcements	Newsletter or annoucements	Newsletters or annoucements	Blog posts	Guides, eBooks, & white papers
			Curated content	

2. New Ways to Market

- Market yourself on personal and organizational channels.

Example: Posting about your exhibition on your own Facebook page and making sure you are tagged in the promotion the gallery is doing for the show on their Facebook page.

-Think creatively, many times you can use social features in new ways.

Example: Instead of your Facebook cover photo simply being something to go with your profile picture, have it be a call to action or of an image of an upcoming event.



-Include the finished products, the works in progress, the good and the bad.

Example would be posting on your instagram your half way done woven textile, talking about the process of making and where in the future someone can see the finished product.

-Again think creatively, do what works for you and fits your uniaue needs.

Example see Alex Menocal's Linkedin page.

Side Note: Remember to be a human being! Don't be afraid to be funny, just also be mindful of your audience. Reply to comments and messages. Make time to generate conversations about the topics you're interested in and your creative practice.

Sharing Social Media Wisdom

There are many sites and people who have used social media to successfully promote themselves in creative fields. Don't be afraid to reach out and ask what they have found to be helpful. Search for artists or creative people you like and see how they have used social media, borrow ideas you like and use them on your own social media outlets.

YOUR ONLINE PRESENCE

Below are some additional pointers from our previous workshops and social media presenters.

When You're Posting...

- When you post, tag individuals and organizations
- Post catchy or interseting images
- Post sneak peaks to images of your upcoming projects or exhibitions.
- Shorten your links so they are not long and overcrowding your feeds. Can use sites like Bit-ly or Owl-ly to do so.
- If you have something going on with an organization or other creatives, collaborate with them, send them our handle, hashtags, and short links. Remember to tag people and location when you can.
- When you have events, exhibitions, or work coming up that you are in or have created, create hashtags in advance and let other participating know.
- Lastly, when you have an event, post photos, videos, and news in the event itself because it will send notifications to attendees and helps maintain engagement.

Make Sure You're Reviewing...

- Constantly review what's working and what's not.
- You can use analytics to strategize around timing and gain valuable insight about your audience.
- Consider your volume, quality engagement is more important than the quantity of posts.
- Be mindful what's trending, consider the context of your posts.

Engagement

The more engagement you get, the more weight your post pulls in the news feed. More engagement = higher organize reach. Make sure the majority of your posts should be educational, informative, inspirational, thought-provoking and humors. (80% should be about your interests, 20% should be about you specifically) Make your social media about your followers. Limit self promotion (like links to sell things or your event openings) and focus on inviting interactions.

Social Media Etiquette...

- Treat others like you want to be treated. Interact with your audience with likes, shares, and commenting on other's posts. This goes for people and organizations.
- Remember to be polite and take a deep breath. Posts that attack or talk poorly about someone else invite criticism of your own work.
- Do not spam your event invite. Create lists to target loyal guests who would specifically be interested in what is happening.

THE REAL LIFE COMPONENT

Remember nothing can replace a real-world presence

Find kindred spirits. Seek out a community of like-minded artists, mentors, and thinkers to bounce ideas off of, collaborate with and share resources. What venues have missions that align with your ideas?
Challenge yourself to meet new people. Set a goal of meeting at least 4 people you'd like to connect with in the next month.
Be genuine. Authenticity and sincerity are key. Don't approach new people by trying to figure out what you can get from them.
Put your work into words. Know how to talk about your work and yourself succinctly.

HELPFUL RESOURCES

1. "Employment Toolkit: Public Image - LinkedIn" By CAPX

Learn about how best to set up a LinkedIn account. Includes examples and additional resources for becoming a LinkedIn pro.

2. "You've Cott Mail: Delivering the news to arts professionals around the world" By Thomas Cott

For more than a decade, Thomas Cott has been providing an invaluable service to the arts community by compiling a digest of arts-related articles in an easy-to-read email every morning. After scouring the Internet for the hottest topics of the day, Thomas delivers his newsletter "You've Cott Mail" to the inboxes of colleagues around the world. CAR Theater Researcher, John Carnwath, recently corresponded with Thomas about his Internet clipping service and the circulation of knowledge among artists and creatives.

3. "Marketing Your Work: Courtesy of New York Foundation for the Arts" By Betsy Kelso

There's no such thing as bad publicity, or so the adage goes. True or not, none of us can deny the power and influence of exposure—particularly in the arts. Glossy photos and eye-catching posters function like "Coming Attractions" at the movies—the perfect teaser. The arts stimulate the senses, and the opportunity to create a marketing tactic for your work can be as challenging and fun as creating the work itself. This site includes tips and additional resources to market your work.

4. "Survival Guide: Social Media and Marketing" by Sue Koch

Utilizing her experience as Chief Navigator, Social Media Strategist, Coach and Speaker at Soaring Solutions Sue takes you through some pointers using various social media platforms to boost your professional presence.

5. "How to use social media to stay on top of your marketing game" by Ashlee Christian

Figuring out a social media marketing strategy can seem overwhelming. Never fear, I invented a hashtag acronym (hacronym?) for you to unleash onto an unsuspecting internet. It's #COINED, a simple way to remember what you have to focus on in social media.